

📌 RESEARCH INTERESTS

Human-Computer Interaction, Social Computing, Science Communication, Virtual/Augmented/Mixed Reality, Visual Storytelling, Computer-supported Cooperative Work

🎓 Education

City University of Hong Kong

Ph.D. of Computer Science (HCI & Social Computing)

Aug. 2021 – current

Kowloon, HK

Australian National University

Master of Computing (Data Science, Professional Computing)

Aug. 2017 – Jul. 2019

Canberra, AU

Beihang University

Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science and Technology

Aug. 2013 – Jun. 2017

Beijing, CN

👤 Work Experience

Research and Teaching Assistant

City University of Hong Kong

Aug. 2021 – current

Kowloon, HK

- CS1302 Introduction to Computer Programming 24/25
- CS2303 Data Structures for Media 21/22, 22/23, 23/24
- JC2066 IT Professionals: Ethical, Legal and Social Issues 22/23, 23/24, 24/25
- CS5481 Data Engineering 21/22

Software Engineer (Full-Stack)

ThoughtWorks Inc.

Oct. 2019 – Apr. 2021

Beijing, CN

- Worked on a large-scale web system (~1M users) for global mobility service in the North America offshore team with a focus on an original attribute-based access control (ABAC) sub-system. Familiar and experienced with software engineering methodologies including OOP, Refactoring, TDD, DDD, and Agile.

🏛 Intern & Visiting

Research Intern

Microsoft Research Asia (MSRA)

July. 2023 – Dec. 2023

Beijing, CN

- Worked on a novel approach to orchestrate and generate motion graphic video clips with human-in-the loop paradigm using large language models (LLMs).
- Supervised by Dr. Yun Wang & Yangyu Huang

Research Assistant

Lanfear Group - Mutation, molecular evolution and phylogenetics (@ANU)

Sep. 2018 – Apr. 2019

Canberra, AU

- Contributed to a bioinformatics research project in algorithm optimization for phylogenetic tree estimation based on the IQ-Tree and ModelFinder software.
- Supervised by Dr. Minh Bui & Dr. Yu Lin

Software Engineer Intern (Back-end)

Netease Youdao Inc.

Oct. 2018 – Dec. 2018

Beijing, CN

- Worked on computational advertisement systems. Individually developed a commercial materials content auditing system for internal use.

IDEA-X Program

Centre for Digital Media

Feb. 2016 – Mar. 2016

Vancouver, CA

- One-month visiting program for learning human-centered design and agile software development.

Research Assistant

Advanced Innovation Center for Big Data and Brain Computing (@BUAA)

Feb. 2015 – Mar. 2017

Beijing, CN

- Worked on cyber security research for vehicular communication systems. Revealed potential vulnerabilities of the onboarding-diagnostics interface (OBD) for CAN-bus based small vehicles.
- Worked on interactive data visualization and analytics for reducing potential cyber security risks based on network traffic data in industrial networks.
- Supervised by Dr. Bo Li

Publications

SpeechCap: Leveraging Playful Impact Captions to Facilitate Interpersonal Communication in Social Virtual Reality

TBA.

Yu Zhang, Yi Wen, Siying Hu, Zhicong Lu

Accepted by CSCW'25, to be published later in 2025

Understanding Communication Strategies and Viewer Engagement with Science Knowledge Videos on Bilibili

Apr. 2023

Yu Zhang, Changyang He, Huanchen Wang, Zhicong Lu

2023 The ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI'23)

DanModCap: Designing a Danmaku Moderation Tool for Video-Sharing Platforms that Leverages Impact Captions

TBA.

Siying Hu, Huanchen Wang, Yu Zhang, Piaohong Wang, Zhicong Lu

Accepted by CSCW'25, to be published later in 2025

Engage Wider Audience or Facilitate Quality Answers? a Mixed-methods Analysis of Questioning Strategies for Research Sensemaking on a Community Q&A Site

Apr. 2024

Changyang He, Yue Deng, Lu He, Qingyu Guo, Yu Zhang, Zhicong Lu, Bo Li

2024 The ACM SIGCHI Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW'24)

"It Felt Like Having a Second Mind": Investigating Human-AI Co-creativity in Prewriting with Large Language Models

Apr. 2024

Qian Wan, Siying Hu, Yu Zhang, Piaohong Wang, Bo Wen, Zhicong Lu

2024 The ACM SIGCHI Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW'24)

Controlling a Car through OBD Injection

Jun. 2016

Yu Zhang, Binbin Ge, Xiang Li, Bin Shi, Bo Li

2016 IEEE 3rd International Conference on Cyber Security and Cloud Computing (CSCloud)

>_ Skills

Software Development

- Programming: C#, Python, ECMAScript, C/C++, Java/Scala
- Web Development: (Front-end) HTML/CSS/JS, React, Vue.js; (Back-end) Flask, ASP.NET, Node.js

- › VR/AR Development: Unreal Engine 4.7/5.1, Meta Quest SDK
- › Database & Cloud: MongoDB, SQLite, Microsoft SQL server, Microsoft Azure
- › Machine Learning & AI: Fine-tuning, Prompt Engineering
- › DevOps: Git, Docker, Shell Scripting, ...

HCI Research

- › User Study: Interview, Survey, Co-design, ...
- › Content analysis: Qualitative Coding

Scholarships & Awards

Institutional Research Tuition Scholarship

City University of Hong Kong, 2023-2024

Postgraduate Studentship

City University of Hong Kong, 2021-2025

Outstanding Graduate of the Class

Beihang University, 2017